Higher Education Open Source Assessment Tool (HEOSAT)

A guided maturity assessment for open source software projects in higher education and edtech.

2026.07 enhanced guidance edition

Progress: 45 / 45 questions scored (100%). **Average score:** 2.29 / 5. **Overall maturity:** Documented.

1. Legal & Licensing

Licensing clarity, copyright provenance, and reuse obligations.

LL1 **The project is distributed with a clearly identified Open Source Initiative (OSI) Approved Open Source License ®.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ◉ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder
https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/7.3.-QualCoder-Development/
Within the software, the About screen.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

LL2 Every repository and distributed artifact includes license and copyright notices.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ◉ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/LICENSE.txt
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/DEPENDENCY_LICENSES.md
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/TRADEMARK.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

LL3 The project documents third-party dependencies and their licenses.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/DEPENDENCY_LICENSES.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

LL4 **The project has a documented contributor licensing or contribution agreement policy.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ◉ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

The "Inbound = Outbound" Default: The project is hosted on GitHub. The GitHub Terms of Service state that by submitting a pull request, the contributor licenses their code under the repository's existing open-source license.
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CONTRIBUTING.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

LL5 **The project explains trademark, name, logo, and brand usage expectations.**

○ **0** Not present	○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
○ **2** Documented	○ **3** Practiced consistently
◉ **4** Measured and improving	○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/TRADEMARK.md

▼ **Why this practice matters**

Licenses govern code, but project names, logos, and marks often have separate rules. Clear brand guidance prevents confusion about official releases, services, endorsements, and compatible distributions.

Higher education perspective. Edtech projects are frequently adopted by campuses and implemented by vendors. Trademark clarity helps institutions identify trusted sources while allowing a healthy service ecosystem.

What good looks like. A mature project documents acceptable use of names and logos, distinguishes community and vendor offerings, and explains how official releases are identified.

Common evidence

- Trademark or brand policy
- Logo usage guidance
- Release authenticity guidance
- Vendor or partner listing criteria

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - Producing Open Source Software
> - Apereo Incubation
> - Open Source Guides

2. Governance & Decision-Making

Transparent authority, participation, and project stewardship.

GV1 The project has a public governance model describing roles, authority, and decision-making processes.

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/GOVERNANCE.md

▼ Why this practice matters

Governance turns a code repository into a durable community. Clear roles and decision rules reduce uncertainty, prevent bottlenecks, and make it possible for new contributors to earn trust.

Higher education perspective. Higher education projects often span multiple institutions. Public governance helps campuses, funders, vendors, and contributors understand how priorities are set and how participation leads to influence.

What good looks like. A mature project publishes maintainership roles, voting or consensus rules, escalation paths, and processes for adding or retiring leaders.

Common evidence

- Governance document
- Maintainer roster
- Decision records
- Documented role definitions

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - Producing Open Source Software
> - Apereo Incubation
> - CHAOSS Metrics Models
> - OSS Watch Openness Rating

GV2 The project records significant technical and community decisions in public venues.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Use of Discussions and Issues pages.
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/ROADMAP.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

GV3 The project has a defined process for adding, reviewing, and removing maintainers or committers.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

GV4 **The project has policies for conflicts of interest, vendor participation, and institutional influence.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CONTRIBUTING.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

GV5 **The project periodically reviews governance effectiveness and updates policies.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/GOVERNANCE.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

3. Community Engagement

Welcoming participation, communication, and community health.

CE1 The project identifies its target users, contributors, adopters, and stakeholder communities.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/
"QualCoder is for individual researchers, academics, students or small teams managing their own qualitative or mixed-methods projects."

▶ **Why this practice matters**

CE2 The project provides welcoming contribution pathways for non-code and code contributors.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CONTRIBUTING.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

CE3 The project has public communication channels with clear participation norms.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ◉ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/discussions

▶ **Why this practice matters**

CE4 The project has a code of conduct and an incident response process.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

CE5 The project measures and responds to community health indicators.

○ **0** Not present	○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
◉ **2** Documented	○ **3** Practiced consistently
○ **4** Measured and improving	○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/discussions
Emails from users
Github start, youtube tutorials view numbers. e.g. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TCLCT893JcM

▼ **Why this practice matters**

Community health is observable through contributor activity, responsiveness, diversity of participation, retention, and governance load. Measurement helps maintainers identify risks before they become crises.

Higher education perspective. Funders and campuses increasingly ask whether projects have broad enough participation to sustain adoption. Community metrics provide evidence while also guiding improvement.

What good looks like. A mature project tracks selected metrics, discusses them publicly, and uses them to improve onboarding, support, and governance.

Common evidence

- Community dashboard
- Contributor activity reports
- Response time metrics
- Survey results and actions

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - CHAOSS Metrics Models
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - Apereo Incubation

4. Documentation & Onboarding

Usable knowledge for adopters, users, administrators, and contributors.

DO1 The project has clear installation, configuration, and upgrade documentation.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Manual
https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/
YouTube tutorials

▶ **Why this practice matters**

DO2 The project provides end-user documentation appropriate to its primary audiences.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ◉ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Manual
https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/
YouTube tutorials

▶ **Why this practice matters**

DO3 **The project documents contributor onboarding, development environment setup, and review workflows.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ◉ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/tree/master/.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/pull_request_template.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

DO4 The project maintains architecture and integration documentation.

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ◉ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Example: LICENSE file URL; governance page; issue tracker evidence; release notes; campus implementation documentation...

▼ Why this practice matters

Architecture documentation helps contributors reason about the system and helps adopters assess fit, extensibility, and operational risk.

Higher education perspective. Edtech rarely stands alone. Campuses need to understand identity, LMS, SIS, data, analytics, accessibility, and privacy integrations before adoption.

What good looks like. A mature project documents major components, data flows, APIs, extension points, deployment models, and integration assumptions.

Common evidence

- Architecture overview
- API documentation
- Integration guides
- Data flow diagrams

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - OpenAPI Specification
> - 1EdTech Standards
> - Diátaxis Documentation Framework
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise

DO5 **Documentation is maintained as part of the release and contribution process.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ◉ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/

▶ **Why this practice matters**

5. Project Operations & Roadmap

Planning, release management, and operational transparency.

PO1 The project publishes a roadmap or planning process that communicates priorities and timelines.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/ROADMAP.md

▶ **Why this practice matters**

PO2 The project uses a public issue tracker with triage, labels, and response expectations.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues

▶ **Why this practice matters**

PO3 **The project follows a predictable release process with changelogs and versioning.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ◉ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/releases

▶ **Why this practice matters**

PO4 The project has defined support channels and support boundaries.

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ◉ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues

▼ Why this practice matters

Support expectations protect both users and maintainers. Clear boundaries explain what the community can provide and where paid, institutional, or vendor support may be needed.

Higher education perspective. Higher education adopters often require operational support beyond community help. Transparent boundaries allow campuses to plan staffing and service contracts responsibly.

What good looks like. A mature project distinguishes community support, professional services, security reporting, and institutional escalation paths.

Common evidence

- Support policy
- Forum or help desk links
- Service provider list
- Security contact

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - Apereo Incubation
> - Producing Open Source Software

PO5 The project tracks maintainership capacity and bus factor risks.

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ◉ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

The team:
https://qualcoder.org/about/

▼ **Why this practice matters**

A project can appear active while depending on too few people. Tracking maintainership capacity reveals risks to review, release, security, and governance work.

Higher education perspective. Grant-funded and campus-born software often depends on a small number of champions. Institutions need evidence that critical knowledge and responsibility are distributed.

What good looks like. A mature project monitors maintainer workload, documents responsibilities, cross-trains contributors, and recruits successors.

Common evidence

- Maintainer roster
- CODEOWNERS or ownership map
- Review load metrics
- Succession plans

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - CHAOSS Metrics Models
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - Producing Open Source Software

6. Security & Risk Management

Vulnerability handling, supply chain risk, and operational trust.

SR1 The project has a documented security policy and private vulnerability reporting process.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ◉ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Uses GitHub dependabot GitHub. Dependabot is an automated tool built into GitHub that monitors dependencies and helps keep them secure and up-to-date.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

SR2 The project uses automated testing, dependency scanning, and continuous integration.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ◉ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Uses GitHub dependabot GitHub. Dependabot is an automated tool built into GitHub that monitors dependencies and helps keep them secure and up-to-date.
Uses GitHub Actions workflows to run tests

▶ **Why this practice matters**

SR3 **The project manages software supply chain integrity for releases.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Github provides SHA checksums for executables

▼ **Why this practice matters**

Users need confidence that release artifacts correspond to reviewed source code and have not been tampered with. Supply chain practices reduce risk from compromised builds, dependencies, or accounts.

Higher education perspective. Higher education institutions increasingly require provenance, SBOMs, and artifact verification for software used in critical academic and administrative systems.

What good looks like. A mature project signs or verifies releases, protects build credentials, documents provenance, and considers SBOM publication.

Common evidence

- Signed releases or checksums
- SBOM
- Protected CI secrets
- Provenance records

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - Supply-chain Levels for Software Artifacts
> - SPDX License List
> - OpenSSF Scorecard
> - OpenSSF Best Practices Badge Program

SR4 **The project documents privacy, data handling, and compliance-relevant practices.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

There is documentation concerning the usage of AI within the software.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

SR5 **The project has an incident response and post-incident learning process.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ◉ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Only via issues.
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues

▶ **Why this practice matters**

7. Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability

Inclusive design and higher education ecosystem fit.

AS1 **The project follows accessibility standards and includes accessibility in testing and release review.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ◉ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Ad hoc feedback. We have introduced colour palettes to show codings colours for different forms of colour blindness. We have feedback from a vision-impaired user who stated in LinkedIn "Worth sharing: finally found a qualitative coder accessible for screen reader users and blind researchers... The software, QualCoder, is compatible with screen readers. I tested it in particular with NVDA,". We have had further contact to further improve accessibility.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

AS2 **The project supports relevant education technology standards and documents interoperability.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/6.1.-Imports-and-Exports/

▶ **Why this practice matters**

AS3 **The project provides APIs, export options, or data portability mechanisms.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ◉ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/6.1.-Imports-and-Exports/
Exports with REFI-QDA standard. (Not guaranteeded for all projects, but genrally works well).

▶ **Why this practice matters**

AS4 **The project supports localization, internationalization, or adaptation for diverse institutional contexts when relevant.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Code contains translatable strings.
Currently translated with native speakers into English, Spanish, German, French. Plus additional langauges support - though inconsistent translation verification.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

AS5 **The project documents supported platforms, browsers, devices, and deployment environments.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ◉ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Supports Windows, macOS, Linux. Overall works the same on each platform, with inconsistencies on some Linux variants (Fedora).

▶ **Why this practice matters**

8. Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit

Evidence that the project solves real higher education needs.

AI1 The project describes its value proposition and use cases for higher education stakeholders.

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ◉ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/
Published projects that used the software:
https://qualcoder.org/using/

▼ Why this practice matters

A project needs to explain the problems it solves and for whom. A clear value proposition helps potential adopters assess fit and helps contributors prioritize meaningful work.

Higher education perspective. Higher education decision-makers include academic, administrative, technical, financial, and compliance stakeholders. Use cases help each group understand relevance.

What good looks like. A mature project publishes use cases, benefits, limitations, and stakeholder-specific adoption materials.

Common evidence

- Use case pages
- Adoption guide
- Stakeholder briefs
- Demo materials

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook
> - EDUCAUSE Open Source resources

AI2 **The project provides evidence of adoption, deployments, or community use.**

- ○ **0** — Not present
- ○ **1** — Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** — Documented
- ○ **3** — Practiced consistently
- ◉ **4** — Measured and improving
- ○ **5** — Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Published Projects Currently over 500 works (October 2026): https://qualcoder.org/using/
Various Universities mention Qualcoder and /or provide tutorials using it. e.g. Temple Universirty, Uppsala University, University of Arizona.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

AI3 The project supports evaluation, pilots, and procurement due diligence.

- (●) **0** Not present
- ( ) **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ( ) **2** Documented
- ( ) **3** Practiced consistently
- ( ) **4** Measured and improving
- ( ) **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Example: LICENSE file URL; governance page; issue tracker evidence; release notes; campus implementation documentation...

▼ Why this practice matters

Even open source software must be evaluated. Materials for pilots and due diligence help organizations understand requirements, costs, risks, and responsibilities.

Higher education perspective. Campus procurement and governance often require accessibility, security, privacy, support, hosting, and integration reviews. Projects that prepare these materials are easier to adopt.

What good looks like. A mature project provides pilot guidance, technical requirements, risk documentation, and implementation planning materials.

Common evidence

- A current and completed HEOSAT report
- Pilot checklist
- Technical requirements
- Risk and compliance notes
- Implementation plan template

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - EDUCAUSE Open Source resources
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook

AI4 **The project documents implementation services, hosting options, or support partners when available.**

- ◉ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Example: LICENSE file URL; governance page; issue tracker evidence; release notes; campus implementation documentation...

▶ **Why this practice matters**

AI5 **The project collects user feedback and uses it to improve product direction.**

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Mainly via GitHub issues page, and email contacts.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

9. Financial & Organizational Sustainability

Resources, continuity, and stewardship beyond initial development.

FS1 The project identifies current and needed resources for maintenance, governance, support, and growth.

- (●) **0** Not present
- ( ) **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ( ) **2** Documented
- ( ) **3** Practiced consistently
- ( ) **4** Measured and improving
- ( ) **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

None.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

FS2 The project has a funding, membership, sponsorship, or institutional support model.

- (●) **0** Not present
- ( ) **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ( ) **2** Documented
- ( ) **3** Practiced consistently
- ( ) **4** Measured and improving
- ( ) **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

None.

▶ **Why this practice matters**

FS3 The project has a plan for post-grant or post-founder continuity.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ◉ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ○ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Mirror page: https://codeberg.org/qualcoder
Maintainers and governance: https://qualcoder.org/about/

▼ Why this practice matters

Many projects fail when founding funding or leadership ends. Continuity planning protects users, contributors, and institutional investments.

Higher education perspective. Research and edtech projects often begin with grants, faculty champions, or campus initiatives. A transition plan helps move from project launch to ongoing service stewardship.

What good looks like. A mature project identifies successor maintainers, institutional homes, archival plans, funding paths, and minimum maintenance commitments.

Common evidence

- Continuity plan
- Succession plan
- Institutional home agreement
- Archival or deprecation plan

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook
> - Producing Open Source Software

FS4 The project maintains transparent infrastructure ownership and operational dependencies.

- ○ **0** Not present
- ○ **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ◉ **2** Documented
- ○ **3** Practiced consistently
- ○ **4** Measured and improving
- ○ **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Transparent coding and documentation all fully available on GitHub and mirrored on Codeberg:
https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/
https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/tree/master
https://codeberg.org/qualcoder
Maintainers: Colin Curtain, Kai Dröge, Justin Missaghieh-Poncet, Lorenzo Salomón have collaborator access to the

▼ Why this practice matters

Projects depend on domains, repositories, package registries, CI systems, cloud accounts, credentials, and communication platforms. Hidden ownership creates continuity and security risks.

Higher education perspective. Campus-born projects often use individual accounts or grant-funded infrastructure. Institutional adoption requires confidence that operational assets are controlled responsibly.

What good looks like. A mature project documents who owns key assets, how access is managed, and what happens when maintainers change roles.

Common evidence

- Infrastructure inventory
- Access control records
- Domain and account ownership documentation
- Backup and recovery notes

Moving to the next level

Use the evidence above to identify the weakest missing practice, assign an owner, and make the next improvement visible in the repository, documentation, governance records, or release process.

> **Learn more**
>
> - OpenSSF Best Practices Badge Program
> - Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise
> - It Takes a Village Guidebook

FS5 **The project periodically assesses sustainability risks and publishes improvement priorities.**

- (●) **0** Not present
- ( ) **1** Ad hoc / emerging
- ( ) **2** Documented
- ( ) **3** Practiced consistently
- ( ) **4** Measured and improving
- ( ) **5** Leading / exemplary

Evidence notes and links

Record URLs, repository paths, policy documents, meeting notes, release artifacts, or other evidence that justify the selected maturity level.

Not present

▶ **Why this practice matters**

HEOSAT Results Report

This printable report summarizes the current assessment results, supporting notes, and evidence links entered by respondents. It can be saved as a PDF and shared with peers, governance bodies, funders, institutional adopters, or posted publicly to document project maturity against the HEOSAT standard.

Attributions, license, and sources informing HEOSAT

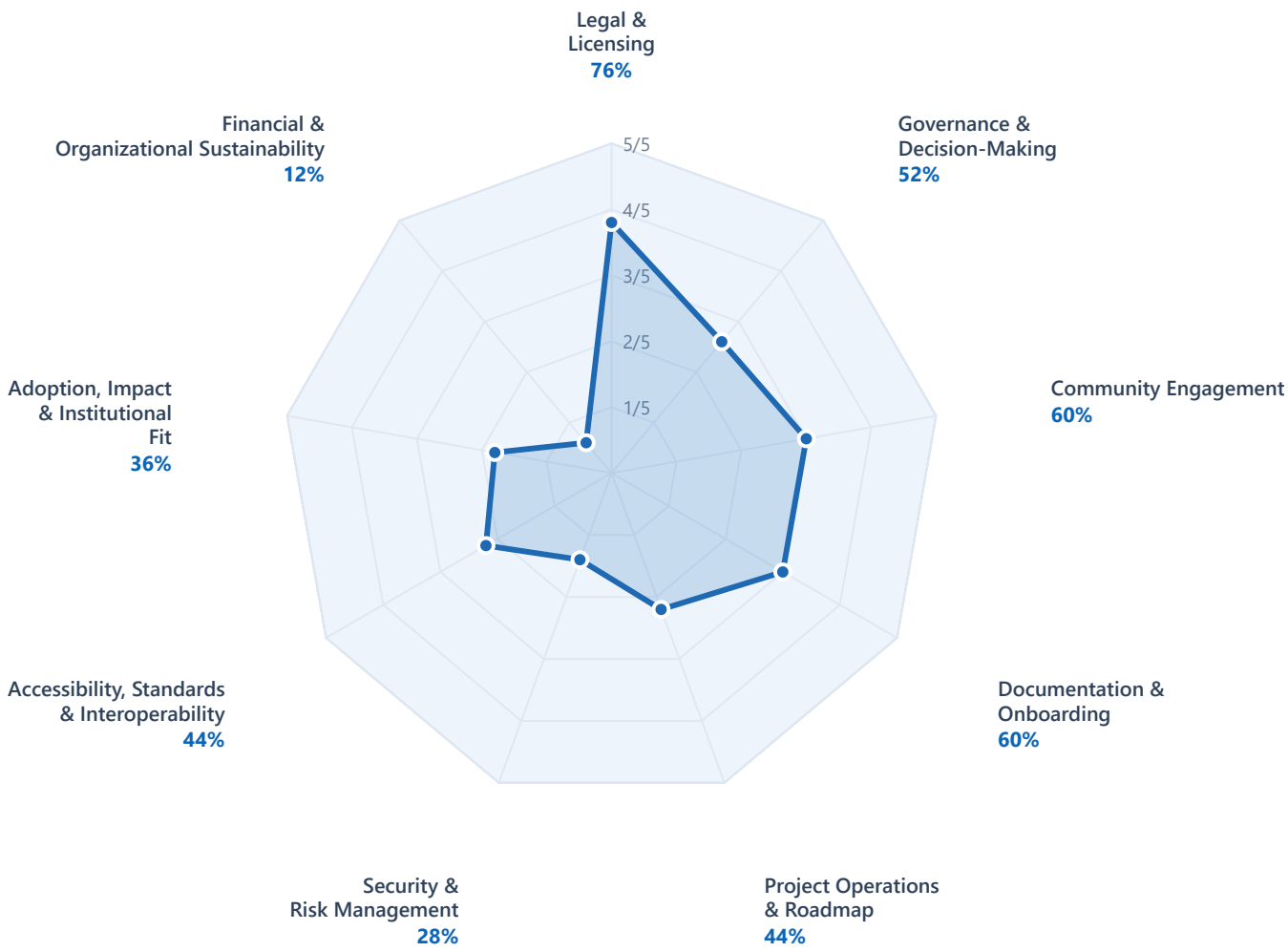
HEOSAT is adapted from and inspired by OSS Watch's Open Source Openness Rating. Except where otherwise noted, HEOSAT guidance content is made available under a Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International License.

- OSS Watch Open Source Openness Rating — Original openness rating framework and Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 licensing reference.
- Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International License — License used for adapted HEOSAT guidance content unless otherwise noted.
- Open Source Initiative — The Open Source Definition — Reference definition for open source licensing and open source freedoms.
- Open Source Initiative — OSI Approved Licenses — Reference list for OSI Approved Open Source Licenses.
- Karl Fogel, Producing Open Source Software — Influence on governance, contribution practices, project operations, and community sustainability guidance.
- Ithaka S+R and Apereo — Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise — Influence on higher education, research software, institutional adoption, and sustainability guidance.
- Ithaka S+R and Apereo — Practical Guide for Sustaining Open Source Software — Influence on sustainability planning, stakeholder alignment, and project improvement practices.
- LYRASIS — It Takes a Village — Influence on community-supported sustainability models for open source and open infrastructure.
- CHAOSS Community — Influence on community health, contributor experience, and open source metrics guidance.
- OpenSSF Best Practices Badge Program — Influence on security, release, and project quality best practices.
- SPDX — Influence on licensing metadata, dependency documentation, and SBOM practices.

Referenced works inform this assessment framework and guidance. They are cited to acknowledge prior work; inclusion does not imply endorsement by the referenced organizations.

Overall score	Maturity band	Questions scored	Questions with evidence notes
46% 2.29 / 5	**Documented**	**45 / 45**	**42**

Maturity by category



Section summary

Section	Scored	Average	Graph
Legal & Licensing	5/5	3.80	
Governance & Decision-Making	5/5	2.60	
Community Engagement	5/5	3.00	
Documentation & Onboarding	5/5	3.00	
Project Operations & Roadmap	5/5	2.20	
Security & Risk Management	5/5	1.40	
Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability	5/5	2.20	
Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit	5/5	1.80	
Financial & Organizational Sustainability	5/5	0.60	

Score distribution

0 — Not present



Summary interpretation

Strongest areas: Legal & Licensing (3.80); Community Engagement (3.00); Documentation & Onboarding (3.00)

Highest-priority improvement areas: Financial & Organizational Sustainability (0.60); Security & Risk Management (1.40); Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit (1.80)

Suggested next step: Use the lowest-scoring questions with missing evidence notes to identify specific documentation, governance, release, security, adoption, or sustainability improvements for the next project cycle.

Question-level results and evidence notes

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
LL1	**Legal & Licensing** The project is distributed with a clearly identified Open Source Initiative (OSI) Approved Open Source License ®.	5 — Leading / exemplary	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/7.3.-QualCoder-Development/ Within the software, the About screen.
LL2	**Legal & Licensing** Every repository and distributed artifact includes license and copyright notices.	4 — Measured and improving	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/LICENSE.txt https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/DEPENDENCY_LICENSES.md https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/TRADEMARK.md

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
LL3	**Legal & Licensing** The project documents third-party dependencies and their licenses.	2 — Documented	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/DEPENDENCY_LICENSES.md
LL4	**Legal & Licensing** The project has a documented contributor licensing or contribution agreement policy.	4 — Measured and improving	The "Inbound = Outbound" Default: The project is hosted on GitHub. The GitHub Terms of Service state that by submitting a pull request, the contributor licenses their code under the repository's existing open-source license. https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CONTRIBUTING.md
LL5	**Legal & Licensing** The project explains trademark, name, logo, and brand usage expectations.	4 — Measured and improving	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/TRADEMARK.md
GV1	**Governance & Decision-Making** The project has a public governance model describing roles, authority, and decision-making processes.	2 — Documented	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/GOVERNANCE.md
GV2	**Governance & Decision-Making** The project records significant technical and community decisions in public venues.	3 — Practiced consistently	Use of Discussions and Issues pages. https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/ROADMAP.md
GV3	**Governance & Decision-Making** The project has a defined process for adding, reviewing, and removing maintainers or committers.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
GV4	**Governance & Decision-Making** The project has policies for conflicts of interest, vendor participation, and institutional influence.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CONTRIBUTING.md
GV5	**Governance & Decision-Making** The project periodically reviews governance effectiveness and updates policies.	2 — Documented	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/GOVERNANCE.md
CE1	**Community Engagement** The project identifies its target users, contributors, adopters, and stakeholder communities.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/ "QualCoder is for individual researchers, academics, students or small teams managing their own qualitative or mixed-methods projects."
CE2	**Community Engagement** The project provides welcoming contribution pathways for non-code and code contributors.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CONTRIBUTING.md
CE3	**Community Engagement** The project has public communication channels with clear participation norms.	4 — Measured and improving	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/discussions
CE4	**Community Engagement** The project has a code of conduct and an incident response process.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
CE5	**Community Engagement** The project measures and responds to community health indicators.	2 — Documented	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/discussions Emails from users Github start, youtube tutorials view numbers. e.g. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TCLCT893JcM
DO1	**Documentation & Onboarding** The project has clear installation, configuration, and upgrade documentation.	3 — Practiced consistently	Manual https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/ YouTube tutorials
DO2	**Documentation & Onboarding** The project provides end-user documentation appropriate to its primary audiences.	4 — Measured and improving	Manual https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/ YouTube tutorials
DO3	**Documentation & Onboarding** The project documents contributor onboarding, development environment setup, and review workflows.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/tree/master/.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/docs/pull_request_template.md
DO4	**Documentation & Onboarding** The project maintains architecture and integration documentation.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	
DO5	**Documentation & Onboarding** Documentation is maintained as part of the release and contribution process.	4 — Measured and improving	https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
PO1	**Project Operations & Roadmap** The project publishes a roadmap or planning process that communicates priorities and timelines.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/blob/master/ROADMAP.md
PO2	**Project Operations & Roadmap** The project uses a public issue tracker with triage, labels, and response expectations.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues
PO3	**Project Operations & Roadmap** The project follows a predictable release process with changelogs and versioning.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/releases
PO4	**Project Operations & Roadmap** The project has defined support channels and support boundaries.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues
PO5	**Project Operations & Roadmap** The project tracks maintainership capacity and bus factor risks.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	The team: https://qualcoder.org/about/
SR1	**Security & Risk Management** The project has a documented security policy and private vulnerability reporting process.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	Uses GitHub dependabot GitHub. Dependabot is an automated tool built into GitHub that monitors dependencies and helps keep them secure and up-to-date.

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
SR2	**Security & Risk Management** The project uses automated testing, dependency scanning, and continuous integration.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	Uses GitHub dependabot GitHub. Dependabot is an automated tool built into GitHub that monitors dependencies and helps keep them secure and up-to-date. Uses GitHub Actions workflows to run tests
SR3	**Security & Risk Management** The project manages software supply chain integrity for releases.	2 — Documented	Github provides SHA checksums for executables
SR4	**Security & Risk Management** The project documents privacy, data handling, and compliance-relevant practices.	2 — Documented	There is documentation concerning the usage of AI within the software.
SR5	**Security & Risk Management** The project has an incident response and post-incident learning process.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	Only via issues. https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/issues
AS1	**Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability** The project follows accessibility standards and includes accessibility in testing and release review.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	Ad hoc feedback. We have introduced colour palettes to show codings colours for different forms of colour blindness. We have feedback from a vision-impaired user who stated in LinkedIn "Worth sharing: finally found a qualitative coder accessible for screen reader users and blind researchers... The software, QualCoder, is compatible with screen readers. I tested it in particular with NVDA,". We have had further contact to further improve accessibility.
AS2	**Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability** The project supports relevant education technology standards and documents interoperability.	2 — Documented	https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/6.1.-Imports-and-Exports/

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
AS3	**Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability** The project provides APIs, export options, or data portability mechanisms.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/6.1.-Imports-and-Exports/ Exports with REFI-QDA standard. (Not guaranteeded for all projects, but genrally works well).
AS4	**Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability** The project supports localization, internationalization, or adaptation for diverse institutional contexts when relevant.	2 — Documented	Code contains translatable strings. Currently translated with native speakers into English, Spanish, German, French. Plus additional langauges support - though inconsistent translation verification.
AS5	**Accessibility, Standards & Interoperability** The project documents supported platforms, browsers, devices, and deployment environments.	3 — Practiced consistently	Supports Windows, macOS, Linux. Overall works the same on each platform, with inconsistencies on some Linux variants (Fedora).
AI1	**Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit** The project describes its value proposition and use cases for higher education stakeholders.	3 — Practiced consistently	https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/ Published projects that used the software: https://qualcoder.org/using/
AI2	**Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit** The project provides evidence of adoption, deployments, or community use.	4 — Measured and improving	Published Projects Currently over 500 works (October 2026): https://qualcoder.org/using/ Various Universities mention Qualcoder and /or provide tutorials using it. e.g. Temple Universirty, Uppsala University, University of Arizona.

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
AI3	**Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit** The project supports evaluation, pilots, and procurement due diligence.	0 — Not present	
AI4	**Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit** The project documents implementation services, hosting options, or support partners when available.	0 — Not present	
AI5	**Adoption, Impact & Institutional Fit** The project collects user feedback and uses it to improve product direction.	2 — Documented	Mainly via GitHub issues page, and email contacts.
FS1	**Financial & Organizational Sustainability** The project identifies current and needed resources for maintenance, governance, support, and growth.	0 — Not present	None.
FS2	**Financial & Organizational Sustainability** The project has a funding, membership, sponsorship, or institutional support model.	0 — Not present	None.
FS3	**Financial & Organizational Sustainability** The project has a plan for post-grant or post-founder continuity.	1 — Ad hoc / emerging	Mirror page: https://codeberg.org/qualcoder Maintainers and governance: https://qualcoder.org/about/

ID	Question	Score	Evidence notes and links
FS4	**Financial & Organizational Sustainability** The project maintains transparent infrastructure ownership and operational dependencies.	2 — Documented	Transparent coding and doucmentation all fully avaiable on GitHub and mirrored on CodeBerg. https://qualcoder.org/doc/en/ https://github.com/ccbogel/QualCoder/tree/master https://codeberg.org/qualcoder Maintainers: Colin Curtain, Kai Dröge, Justin Missaghieh-Poncet, Lorenzo Salomón have collaborator access to the GiotHub project.
FS5	**Financial & Organizational Sustainability** The project periodically assesses sustainability risks and publishes improvement priorities.	0 — Not present	Not present

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- Open Source Initiative — OSI Approved Licenses — Reference list for OSI Approved Open Source Licenses.
- Karl Fogel, Producing Open Source Software — Influence on governance, contribution practices, project operations, and community sustainability guidance.
- Ithaka S+R and Apereo — Sustaining Open Source Software in the Research Enterprise — Influence on higher education, research software, institutional adoption, and sustainability guidance.
- Ithaka S+R and Apereo — Practical Guide for Sustaining Open Source Software — Influence on sustainability planning, stakeholder alignment, and project improvement practices.
- LYRASIS — It Takes a Village — Influence on community-supported sustainability models for open source and open infrastructure.
- CHAOSS Community — Influence on community health, contributor experience, and open source metrics guidance.
- OpenSSF Best Practices Badge Program — Influence on security, release, and project quality best practices.
- SPDX — Influence on licensing metadata, dependency documentation, and SBOM practices.

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